
State of the Web 2020–2025

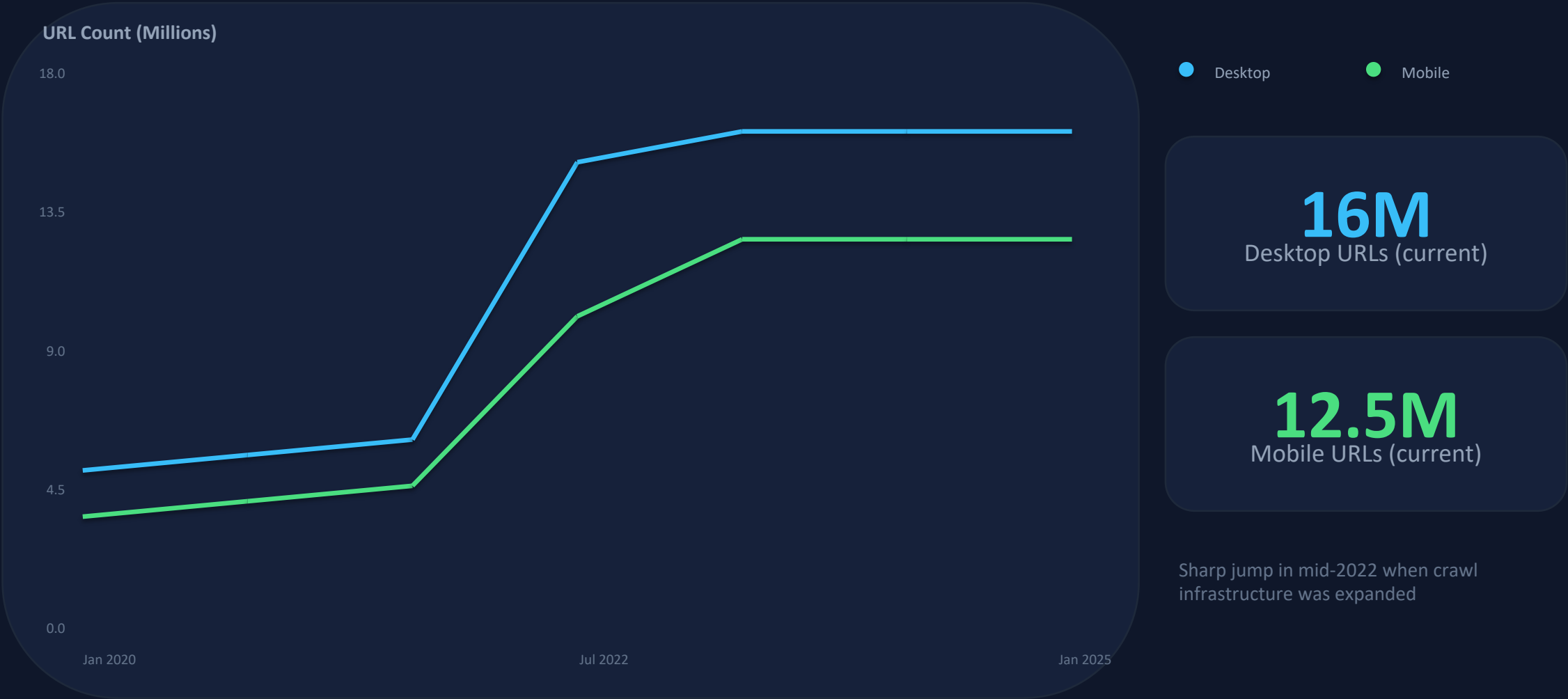
Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

Data Source: HTTP Archive · Jan 2020 – Mar 2026 · Desktop & Mobile Crawls

For web performance engineers and front-end architects

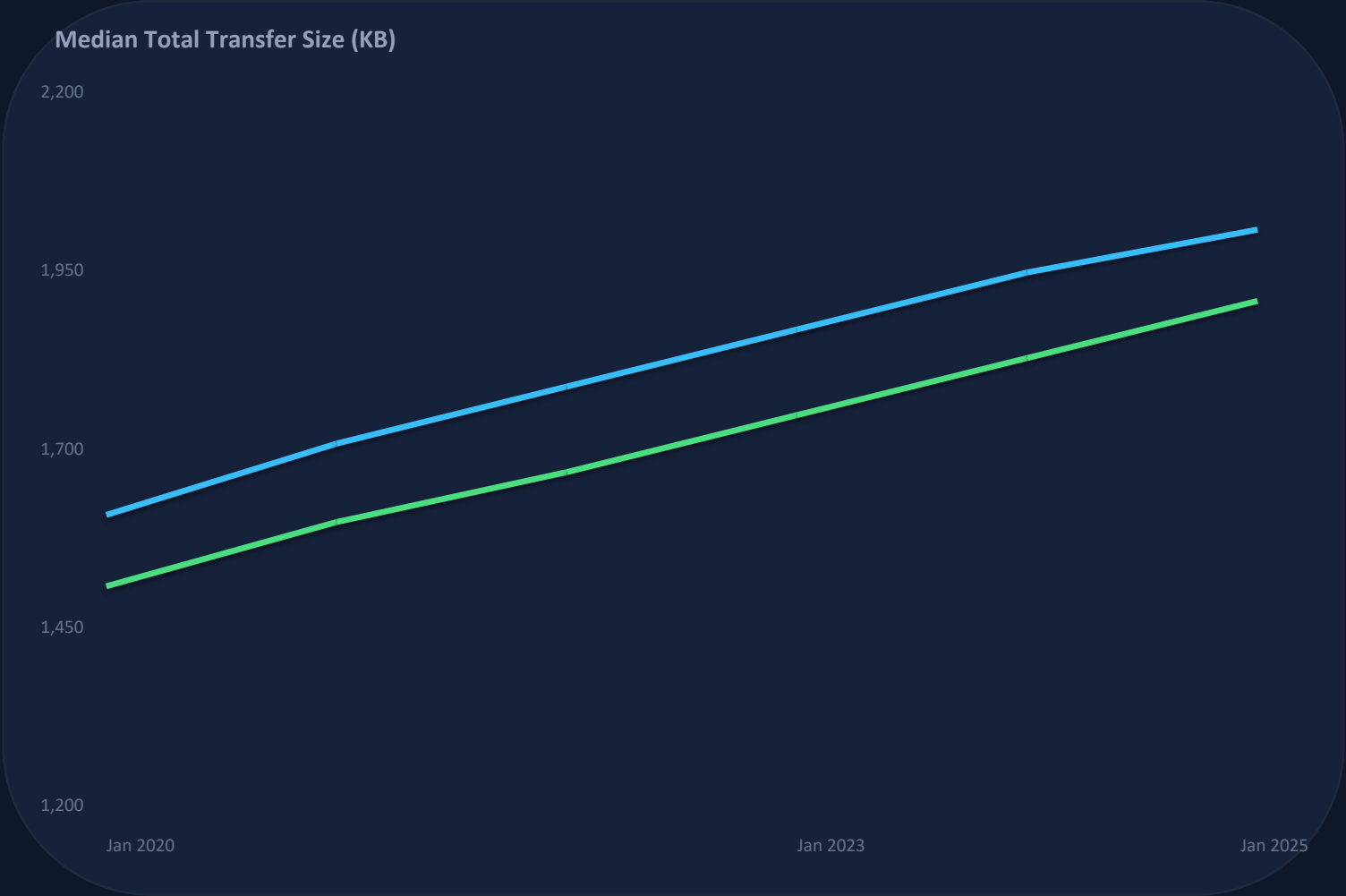
Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

WTFP Archive sample growth — desktop and mobile URL counts over time



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total kilobytes transferred — median desktop vs. mobile, Jan 2020 to present



● Desktop ● Mobile

~2,000 KB
Desktop median (current)

▲ ~25%
Growth since 2020

>4,000 KB
75th percentile (desktop)

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

More requests, fewer connections — multiplexing delivers real efficiency gains

MEDIAN REQUESTS PER PAGE

76

Desktop ▲ 2.7%

71

Mobile ▲ 2.9%

Request counts grew only ~3% over 5 years — pages are adding richer assets, not more files

TCP CONNECTION DECLINE

▼ 14.3%

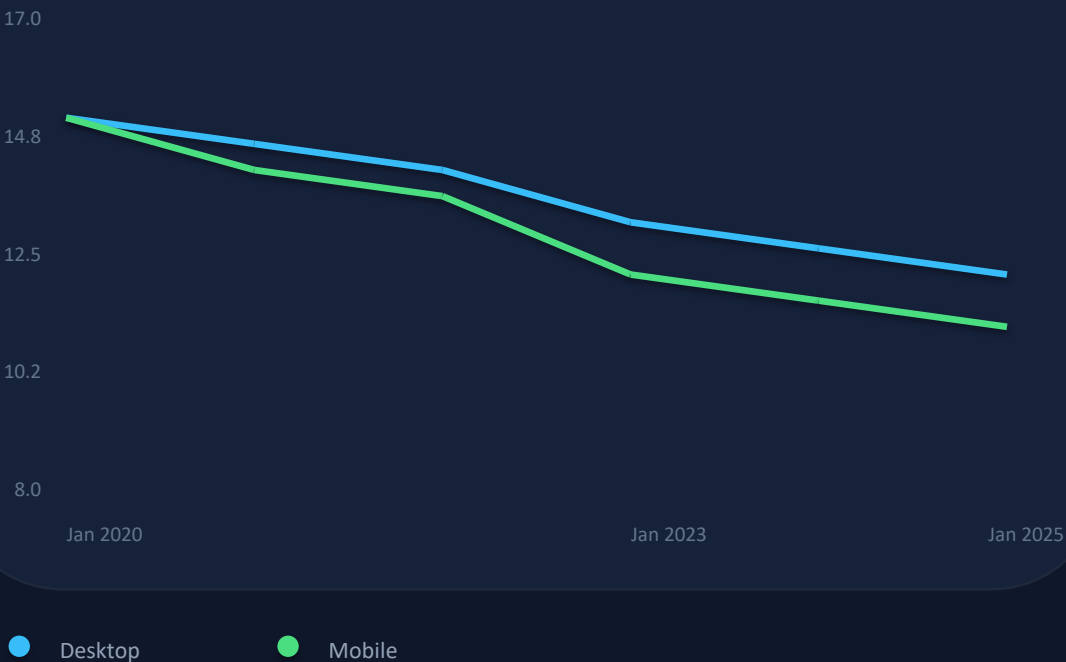
Desktop

▼ 26.7%

Mobile

TCP CONNECTIONS PER PAGE (MEDIAN)

Declining connections despite rising requests



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web

99%+

of all requests now use HTTPS

Desktop: 99.2%

Mobile: 99.1%

Up ~19–20 percentage points since early 2020

HTTPS adoption trajectory (%)



HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

Protocol adoption snapshot — HTTP/3 growing from near-zero to mainstream

CURRENT PROTOCOL MIX

HTTP/2

58.6%

Desktop requests

57.6%

Mobile requests

HTTP/3

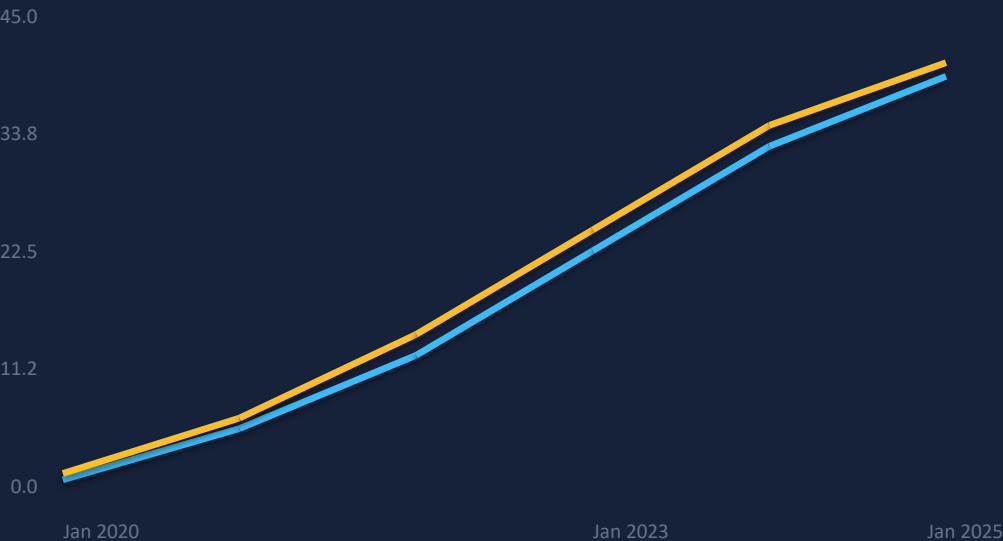
38.7%

Desktop support

40.0%

Mobile support

HTTP/3 Support Growth (%)



● Desktop ● Mobile

Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support (Alt-Svc advertised) rather than actual usage, since fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

The font-display CSS property prevents Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) during font loading

40.1%

Desktop adoption

42.5%

Mobile adoption

▲ 14.9%

Desktop growth since 2020

▲ 61.0%

Mobile growth since 2020

OPPORTUNITY

~58%

of pages still risk Flash of Invisible Text

Adding font-display: swap or optional to @font-face rules is a quick, impactful performance win.

Measured by Lighthouse audit — percentage of pages with font-display set on all web font declarations

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Five major findings from the HTTP Archive, Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

▲ 25%

Page Weight Keeps Climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.

99%+

HTTPS Is the New Baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.

~40%

HTTP/3 Is the Fastest-Growing Metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

▼ 15–
27%

Fewer TCP Connections

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.

~40–42%

Font-Display Still Underused

At ~40–42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.

→ Benchmark your own site against these baselines using HTTP Archive data at <httparchive.org>